MOST IMMEDIATE

सत्यमेव जयते

भारत सरकार, गृह मंत्रालय
Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India
भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार का कार्यालय
OFFICE OF THE REGISTRAR GENERAL, INDIA
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जनगणना प्रभाग/Census Division

आज़ादी का अमृत महोत्सव

No. 9/30/2025 - CD (CEN) (C No. 55011) **Dated: 04-12-2025**

CENSUS OF INDIA 2027 – CIRCULAR No. 6

Subject: Formation and identification of Slum Enumeration Blocks for Slum Demography

India has experienced a steady rise in urbanisation, driven by industrial growth, economic opportunities, and migration since the beginning of the 21st century. In India, Cities have always been the hubs of economic activity, attract people from rural areas and smaller towns in search of better livelihoods. However, rapid population growth combined with inadequate planning has put immense pressure on limited land and infrastructure. This has led to the expansion of slums—clusters of poorly built shelters lacking basic amenities such as drinking water supply, sanitation, drainage, and waste disposal etc. Factors contributing to this growth of slum areas include soaring land prices, shortage of affordable housing programmes for the urban poor, and the persistent inflow of rural migrants despite insufficient physical infrastructure. As a result, informal settlements and squatter colonies have become a common feature of most major cities, widening the gap between the demand and supply of essential services and degrading the overall quality of urban life. During Census 2011, 1.23 lakhs Slums Enumeration blocks (EBS) were reported across the country and the total slum population was 6.55 crore.

2. Despite continuous efforts by the State/ UT administrations to contain growth of slums, these have become an integral part of the phenomenon of urbanization and are, in a way, manifestation of overall socio-economic policies and planning in the States and the Country. The slum dwellers contribute to the economy of the city, being a source of affordable labour supply for production in both the organised and unorganised sectors of the economy. Comprehensive information on the slums is thus essential for formation of an effective and coordinated policy for their improvement/ rehabilitation.

3. The 2011 Census collected detailed demographic data separately for slum areas across the country in all statutory towns irrespective of its population size. In Census 2027 also, data pertaining to 'Slums' will be collected separately and tabulated for all statutory towns irrespective of their population size. For this, the identification and formation of Slum Houselisting Blocks (HLBs) / Enumeration Blocks (EBs) prior to the conduct of each phase of Census 2027, i.e., Houselisting and Housing Census and Population Enumeration is necessary. However, no separate or additional question will be canvassed for the data on slums and the same schedule to be canvassed during Houselisting & Housing Census and the Population Enumeration will be used for this purpose. For each statutory town, distinct identity of areas termed as 'Slums' will be maintained to enable data processing and separate tabulation.

4. The concept of slums and their definition vary considerably across the States/UTs depending upon the socio-economic conditions or local perceptions. The nomenclature also varies from one region to another. For example, in Delhi, slums are commonly known as 'Jhuggi Jhopdi', whereas in Mumbai they are called 'Jhopadpatti or Chawls'. Similarly, other known names are 'Ahatas' in Kanpur, 'Bustees' in Kolkata and 'Cheris' in Chennai. However, most of these slums have the same physical characteristics.

5. Section 3 of the Slum Areas (Improvement and Clearance) Act, 1956 defines 'Slums areas' as mainly those residential areas where dwellings are unfit for human habitation due to dilapidation, overcrowding, faulty designs of buildings,

narrowness or faulty arrangement of streets, lack of ventilation, light or sanitation facilities or any combination of these factors which are detrimental to safety, health and morals. Thus, conceptually Slums are perceived as compact overcrowded residential areas (and not isolated or scattered dwellings) unfit for habitation due to lack of one or more of the basic infrastructures like drinking water, sanitation, electricity, sewerage, streets etc. In addition to this Central Legislation, several States have their own independent Acts where 'Slums' are defined.

6. Like in Census 2011, the Slums are to be divided into three categories Namely-Notified, Recognised and Identified. The definitions and codes used in the 2011 Census will be continued for 2027 Census as detailed below:

(i) **Notified slums:** All notified areas in a town or city notified as 'Slum' by State/UT Administration or Local Government under any Act including 'Slum Act' may be considered as Notified slums and assigned code 1;

(ii) **Recognized slums:** All areas recognized as 'Slum' by State/UT Administration or Local Government, Housing and Slum Boards, which may have not been formally notified as slum under any act may be considered as Recognized slums and assigned code 2;

(iii) **Identified slums:** There may be a compact area of at least 300 population and/or about 60-70 households of poorly built congested tenements, in unhygienic environment usually with inadequate infrastructure and lacking in proper sanitary and drinking water facilities. Such areas should be identified by Charge Officer and also inspected by an officer of the Directorate of Census Operations (DCO). Proper entries need to be recorded in the Charge Register for all such areas. Such areas may be considered as Identified slums and assigned code 3;

7. Slum areas may be identified in all statutory towns irrespective of the population size. The towns may already be having a list of notified or recognized Slums for their areas. A copy of the list/notifications is to be procured from the appropriate State/UT authorities. While forming HLB or EB in any ward or town,

separate block or blocks should be formed for slum areas both at the Houselisting stage and later at Population Enumeration stage. Keeping a separate identity of the 'Slum Houselisting/Enumeration Blocks' will enable to compile and tabulate the data for 'Slums' in both the phases of Census. However, it needs to be ensured that a block formed out of 'Slum' does not cut across ward boundaries and no non-slum area is mixed up with the slum area, how small it may be. If it becomes necessary to make readjustments in the boundaries of Houselisting Blocks at the time of Population Enumeration, these may be done within the area of 'Slum' so that comparable data for both the phases is available. The concordance may be ensured between Houselisting and Population Enumeration Blocks for the linking of two sets of data.

8. Each Houselisting Block/Enumeration Block will be assigned one of the four codes, namely, **Notified slum-1, Recognized slum-2, Identified slum-3** (as defined in para 6) **and Non-slum-4.** A separate column will be provided in the Charge Register for this purpose. The size of Slum HLB/EB should usually be the same as the normal HLB/ EB i.e., 700-800 population. However, to meet various local situations, the Charge Officer in consultation with officer from DCO will use his discretion carefully while fixing the size of the Slum Enumeration Block. For example, if the population is say 850 in a slum area, then only one Slum Houselisting/Enumeration Block needs to be formed. Similarly, in case the population is lower than the range given above but not less than 300, then only one independent Slum Houselisting/Enumeration Block will be formed. It will not be clubbed with the neighbouring normal Houslisting/Enumeration block. In yet another situation the population of the slum area may be 1000. In such a case, two independent Slum Houselisting/Enumeration Blocks are to be formed. In such scenario, one Enumerator is to be allotted multiple HLBs/EBs i.e., small slum HLB/EB and another slum or non-slum HLB/EB, both together fulfilling the normal workload. In this case, concerned Enumerator is to maintain records separately. The list of slum HLBs/EBs in each Charge will be prepared and kept at the Census Directorate.

9. The data on 'Slums' being very important and a pre-requisite for urban planning, all town authorities are to ensure that 'Slum Houselisting/Enumeration Blocks' are carefully identified and displayed properly in the Charge Registers of every Statutory Town. After completing the identification of 'Slum Houselisting/Enumeration Blocks', a Charge-wise consolidated list for all Districts/M.Corps for the State/UT should be prepared and sent to the concerned DCO. The first consolidated Charge-wise list of Slum Blocks will be for the Houselisting Operations while the next list will be for Population Enumeration phase of Census 2027.

10. The receipt of this circular may please be acknowledged and follow up action taken in this regard may please be intimated.

Narayanm 04/12/2025

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To

The Chief Secretary
All States/UTs

Copy for necessary action to:

1. All State/UTs Coordinators
2. All Directorate of Census Operations
3. All heads of Divisions of ORGI (including Language Division, Kolkata)
4. Census Divisions, ORGI
5. PPS to RG&CCI
6. PPS to Addl. Registrar Generals (S)/(SK), DDG (BD), ORGI
7. PS to Sr. Technical Director (IT), Shastri Park, for uploading on Census website